

JACKSON C. TURNER

QUANTUM RESEARCH SCIENTIST | APPLIED MATHEMATICIAN

New York, NY | me@jacktrnr.com | jacktrnr.com | github.com/jacktrnr

Education

Columbia University

MS/Ph.D. in Applied Mathematics (GPA: 3.97)

June 2026

New York, NY

Engineering Presidential Fellow. Dissertation: Resonance-induced nonlinear bound states and their orbital stability. Advisor: M. I. Weinstein.

University of Utah

Honors B.S. in Applied Mathematics & Physics (GPA: 3.95)

May 2021

Salt Lake City, UT

Presidential Scholar. Developed mesh-free PDE eigensolvers

Experience

Harmoniqs

Brooklyn, NY

Quantum Research Scientist

2026 – Present

- Develop the mathematical and computational machinery of quantum control for neutral-atom hardware, focusing on atom transport and optical tweezer control
- Build Julia software for atom control, implementing optimization routines for tweezer trajectories and atom rearrangement

Atlas Fusion

Remote

Mathematical Physicist

Feb – Jun 2026

- Built numerical solvers in Julia for plasma stability problems

Columbia University, APAM Department

New York, NY

Graduate Research Assistant

May 2022 – Present

- Connected quantum scattering theory to nonlinear bifurcation theory, establishing how resonances in linear wave operators generate nonlinear bound states; paper under review at *Nonlinearity*
- Developed perturbative orbital stability criteria for Hamiltonian systems; manuscript in preparation
- Built numerical solvers for scattering, bifurcation, and dynamical systems problems with $< 10^{-8}$ tolerances
- Invited talk, Simons Collaboration on Extreme Wave Phenomena; Best Poster, Joint Alabama–Florida Conference (2025)

Zap Energy, Theory & Modeling Division

Everett, WA

Research Intern

Jun – Aug 2025

- Achieved $720\times$ speedup (4 hours $\rightarrow$ 20 seconds) building eigenvalue solver in Julia for MHD linear stability analysis; used predictor-corrector continuation with arclength parameterization to track embedded eigenvalues through bifurcations
- Performed spectral analysis of axisymmetric ideal MHD equilibria; studied onset of Kelvin–Helmholtz and shear-driven Mack-mode instabilities via bifurcation theory and complex analysis
- Identified novel plasma instability mechanism in sheared-flow Z-pinch configurations; preprint at arXiv:2608.00291

Volunteer Program Leader

Hong Kong

Full-time Service

2015 – 2017

- Led teams of 10–20 volunteers across multiple districts, managing goal-setting and training; fluent in Cantonese

Technical Skills

Physics Quantum optimal control, Hamiltonian systems & stability theory, spectral perturbation theory, quantum mechanics, MHD & plasma modeling, eigenvalue problems in complex geometries, bifurcation & parameter continuation methods

Solvers & Algorithms Quantum optimal control (atom transport, optical tweezer control), eigenvalue solvers, parameter continuation and bifurcation tracing (AUTO, BifurcationKit.jl), lattice eigenvalue optimization (flat tori, sphere packing generalizations), spectral methods, ML algorithms

Programming Julia, Python (NumPy, SciPy), MATLAB; familiar with Fortran, PyTorch

Mathematics Spectral theory, scattering theory, bifurcation theory, perturbation methods, variational calculus, constrained optimization, complex analysis, Hamiltonian mechanics

Publications

- Crews, D. W. & J. C. Turner. “On the ideal stability of the sheared-flow Z pinch.” arXiv:2608.00291, 2026.
- Turner, J. C. & M. I. Weinstein. “Lyapunov stability of resonance-induced nonlinear bound states.” In preparation, 2026.
- Turner, J. C. & M. I. Weinstein. “Resonance-induced nonlinear bound states.” arXiv:2510.19538, 2025.
- Kao, C.-Y., B. Osting & J. C. Turner. “Flat Tori with Large Laplacian Eigenvalues.” *SIAM J. Appl. Algebra Geom.*, 2023.
- Turner, J. C., E. Cherkaev & D. Wang. “Expansion Method for Laplace–Beltrami Eigenfunctions.” arXiv:2210.10982, 2022.